thanks to the NA's nimbleness. But then the real horror came, when I overheard the medical officer prescribing some injections. My heart sank.

'I'll take any medicine they give me, but no injections. Please,' I pleaded, teary-eyed.

'But you're very weak, Gunju, the injections are necessary. It's okay, I'm with you,' he tried to make me understand.

But I was already panicking. I would have fled if I had the energy to run. But I sat in the wheelchair, helpless. When we entered the injection room, the NA made me sit on an inclined chair and asked me to place my arm on the armrest. Half reluctantly, I followed his instructions but kept looking at Papaji with pleading, tear-filled eyes.

'It'll be over before you know it,' he said. All hell broke loose when I caught a glimpse of a big, pointy syringe as the NA prepared the first injection.

'No, please, Papaji, no injection,' I whimpered. After another moment, I was literally screaming.

'Listen to me,' Papaji said, quite loudly, and my whining tuned down to a sob. He then gently held my hand, cupped my chin and said, 'It'll be just one small prick. You won't even feel it. I promise. Trust me . . . just a small prick.'

'You're lying,' I said faintly.

'Get the first injection and see for yourself,' Papaji said.

'No,' I mumbled, 'first you get one. I want to see how they do it.' The NA chuckled at this. Papaji sighed.

'I can show you someone else who might be getting an injection right now,' the NA suggested. A loud 'no' was my reply.

'It's okay,' Papaji turned to the NA and said, 'You give me some injection, something like an anti-tetanus or something.'

Amazed by this strange agreement, the NA prepared an injection for Papaji. I stopped crying and focused on the process. I saw the NA tapping on Papaji's arm to find the right vein. As he brought the syringe closer to Papaji's skin, I leaned forward for a closer look. The moment the syringe pushed its way inside Papaji's skin and the NA drew some blood, I shifted